PRESS & MEDIA PACK

2026 · FIRST EDITION

HOME OF THE BLACK HORSE BEAMISH

Red Row Estate

Three centuries of Beamish valley life, one family, thirty-seven acres, and the open road.

BLACK HORSE BEAMISH · OLD RED ROW ROOMS · RED ROW RETREAT
HUCKLEBERRY COTTAGE · ORCHARD MARQUEE · ASTON WORKSHOP · CAR BARN

BEAMISH · COUNTY DURHAM · DH9 0RW

One estate. One family. Three centuries of stories.

A thirty-seven-acre working country estate on the side of the Beamish conservation valley, gathered around an inn that has stood on Red Row since about 1690. A place to eat, sleep, marry, drive, roast, grow, or simply pull in for the night.

c.1690	37	12	349	1 mile
FIRST COTTAGE ON RED ROW	ACRES OF VALLEY, WOOD AND LAVENDER	OAK-FITTED ROOMS AT OLD RED ROW	SEATED IN THE ORCHARD MARQUEE	TO BEAMISH MUSEUM

A note for editors, producers and picture desks

This pack is written to be lifted from. Every section stands alone, every figure not flagged for checking is one the estate is willing to be quoted on, and every image plate marks a photograph the estate can supply at print resolution, or arrange to have taken. Where a claim rests on family memory rather than a document, we say so, and the verification notes at the back set out what is still being checked.

Red Row is unusual because it is not one story but a dozen that happen to share a postcode: a 300-year-old pub, a Sunday lunch, a wedding under canvas for 349, a DB5 on a lift, a Caterham on a Sunday morning, a motorhome parked up for free under a big sky, a lavender field in July. Pick the one that suits your readers. We will make the rest easy.

INSIDE THIS PACK

01 The Estate Thirty-seven acres, one postcode
02 The Black Horse A 1690s cottage, restored
03 Red Row through time 1690 to 2026
04 Stay Rooms, Retreat, Huckleberry Cottage
05 Celebrate Marquee, suite and the big field
06 Motoring Aston Workshop and Car Barn
07 The open road Free motorhome stopovers

ALSO INSIDE

08 Land and larder Lavender, gardens, coffee
09 The Fountain family Farmer, restorer, publican
10 Story angles Twelve pitches to commission
11 Facts and boilerplate Numbers and contacts
12 Image library Plates and shot briefs
13 Notes and checks What is still being checked

SECTION 01

The Estate

Thirty-seven acres on the side of the Beamish valley

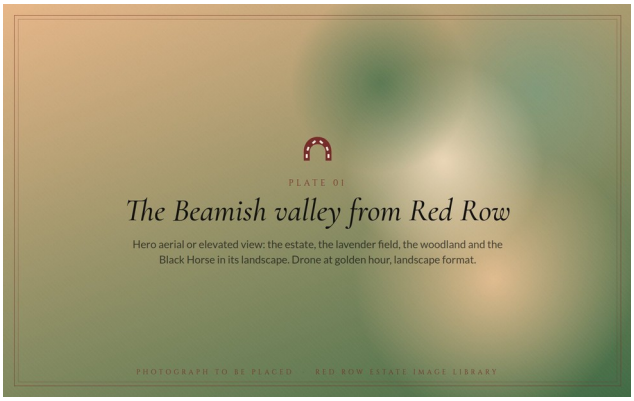


Plate 01 · The Beamish valley from Red Row. Hero aerial, golden hour.

Red Row Estate sits high on the side of the Beamish conservation valley in County Durham, a mile from Beamish Museum, one of the North East's most visited attractions, and within a stroll of Causey Arch, the oldest surviving single-arch railway bridge in the world. Tanfield Railway, which bills itself as the world's oldest railway, is the next valley over.

The estate runs to thirty-seven acres of pasture, woodland, orchards and kitchen gardens, with one of the very few lavender fields in the North East of England laid out along the valley's edge. Wildlife has the run of it. So, in the family's own phrase, do the farmyard antiques.

What began around 1690 as a row of quarrymen's and colliers' cottages is now home to a 300-year-old inn and restaurant, eighteen bedrooms across three very different places to stay, two licensed wedding venues, an internationally known Aston Martin specialist, a sports and classic car showroom that is an official Caterham retailer, and free overnight stopovers for motorhomes and campervans. Everything on the estate is owned and run by one family, the Fountains, who have lived on Red Row for forty-five years.

HOSPITALITY

- The Black Horse Beamish: bar, restaurant, courtyard, play park
- Old Red Row Rooms: twelve oak-fitted bedrooms
- Red Row Retreat: two suites, two doubles, sleeps ten
- Huckleberry Cottage: a private two-bedroom cottage
- The Orchard Marquee and the George Ridley Suite
- Motorhome and campervan stopovers

MOTORING AND LAND

- Aston Workshop: restoration, service, parts and sales since 1988
- Car Barn: sports, prestige and classic cars; Caterham retailer
- Car Barn Drivers' Club monthly meets and The Hill
- The Great North Classic Car Show field, space for 550 exhibits
- Lavender field, woodland and ten acres of vegetable gardens and orchards
- Red Row Estate Coffee

"A glorious thirty-seven-acre sprawl with lavender field and woodland, riddled with wildlife and farmyard antiques."

FROM THE ESTATE'S OWN DESCRIPTION OF RED ROW

SECTION 02

The Black Horse

A Shafto estate cottage, twenty-eight souls, one long restoration

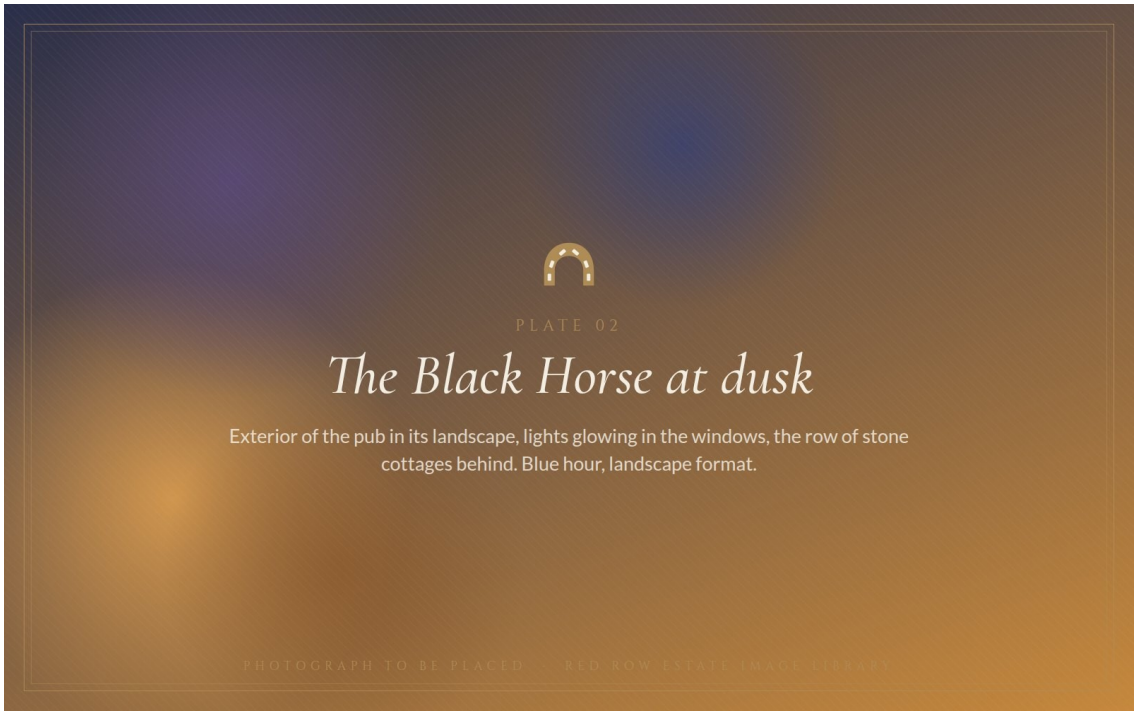


Plate 02 · The Black Horse at dusk, lights in the windows, the row of cottages behind.

The Shafto estate cottages

The building that is now the Black Horse was put up around 1690 as the first and largest of ten cottages on Red Row, on the Shafto family's Beamish estate. This is the family of Bobby Shafto, MP for County Durham and the subject of the song every child in the North East can still sing. The leases came with a condition: each cottage had to provide one able-bodied man for the quarry or the pit.

A lease survives in the Shafto (Beamish) Papers at Durham University for a dwelling house at Beamish Red Row dated 1740, and it refers to an earlier lease still. The row was never grand. It was where the men who cut Beamish stone and Beamish coal came home to.

Twenty-eight under one roof

By the 1851 census, twenty-eight people were living at the Black Horse: colliery workers and their children, domestic servants and, the census notes, scholars. The house had become a licensed public house by about 1850, and it has been one ever since.

The matchbox bar

Earlier landlords brought matchboxes back from every journey they made and pinned them up around the bar. The collection grew into a tradition, and the tradition became part of the character of the room. It is the sort of detail that photographs beautifully and that regulars still talk about.

Four years, one pub

Bob Fountain, whose Aston Martin workshop already sat next door, bought the Black Horse in 2006. He had first drunk in it more than three decades earlier. The restoration took four years and the pub reopened in 2010 with its flagstone floors, its open fires and three centuries of character intact; CAMRA's Durham branch lists it as a pub that kept its atmosphere. Within a decade it had become one of the best-known

gastro pubs in the region and a wedding and events venue in its own right.

Today

The Black Horse serves breakfast every day, dines all day Monday to Saturday, and gives Sunday over entirely to a lunch menu that changes every week. Afternoon tea comes in three versions: classic, with or without a glass of Prosecco; a Gentleman's tea with heartier bites; and a children's size. The bar keeps two changing cask ales, with Theakston and Timothy Taylor regulars. Dogs are welcome in the bar and the courtyard, there is a play park for children, and ten acres of the estate's own vegetable gardens and orchards stand behind the phrase ‘field to plate’.



Plate 03 · Firelight and flagstones: the bar, the fire and the matchbox collection.

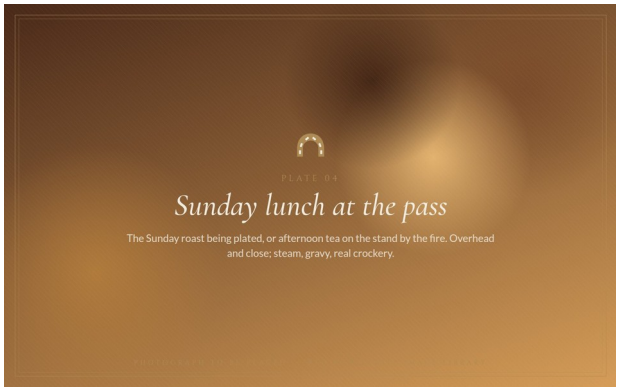


Plate 04 · Sunday lunch at the pass, or afternoon tea by the fire.

c.1690	c.1850	28	2006	2010
Built as a cottage	Licensed as an inn	Residents in the 1851 census	Bought by Bob Fountain	Reopened after restoration

Opening hours worth printing

Breakfast Every day, 8am to 10am

All-day dining Monday to Saturday, 12 noon to 9pm

Afternoon tea Monday to Saturday, 12 noon to 4pm; book by 6pm the day before

Sunday lunch 12 noon to 6pm; a different menu every week

Bar Two changing cask ales; dogs welcome in the bar and courtyard

SECTION 03

Red Row through time

Three centuries on one page

c.1690	Ten cottages are built on Red Row on the Shafto family's Beamish estate; the family's Bobby Shafto, MP for County Durham, is the one in the song. The first and largest cottage becomes the Black Horse.
1740	A lease for a dwelling house at Beamish Red Row is recorded in the Shafto (Beamish) Papers, now at Durham University, referring to an earlier lease.
c.1850	The cottage is licensed as a public house.
1851	The census records twenty-eight people living at the Black Horse: colliery workers and their children, servants and scholars.
1926	Vaux Breweries of Sunderland acquires the Black Horse, said within the family to be the oldest pub in the Vaux estate. Brewery visitors are said to have arrived by Vaux dray. *Family account; being checked against Vaux records.*
Early 1970s	A young Bob Fountain first drinks at the Black Horse. He has been a customer for fifty-five years.
c.1981	Bob makes Red Row his home: a cottage from the 1690s, two acres and a flock of sheep.
1988	A friend arrives up the drive in a DB5. Bob restores one in the sheep shed, sells it, and founds Aston Workshop with the proceeds.
2006	Bob buys the Black Horse. A four-year restoration begins.
2010	The Black Horse reopens: flagstones, open fires, eclectic furniture, matchboxes.
2022	The Great North Classic Car Show returns to the Red Row field after the pandemic years.
2025	Car Barn Beamish, run by Bob's son Fraser, joins the Caterham Cars UK retailer network.
2026	The Hill, a celebration of all things Aston Martin, returns to Red Row on Sunday 9 August. This press pack is issued.

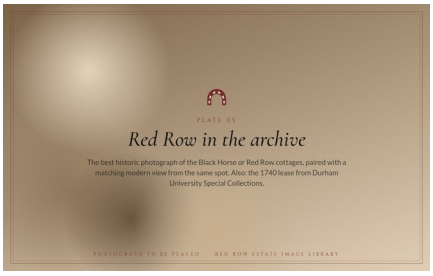


Plate 05 · Red Row in the archive.

IN THE ARCHIVE

The Shafto (Beamish) Papers at Durham University Archives and Special Collections document the Beamish estate, its families and its properties, including Red Row, from the eighteenth century. For a feature, the most powerful image is the oldest photograph of the Black Horse or the cottages placed beside the same view today, with the 1740 lease itself requested from Special Collections.

SECTION 04

Stay

Eighteen bedrooms, three very different ways to sleep on the estate

Everything on Red Row is a two-minute walk from everything else. Guests can eat at the Black Horse, sleep above the valley, and be at Beamish Museum before the trams start running.



Plate 06 · An Old Red Row bedroom: handmade bed, oak, copper roll-top tub.

Old Red Row Rooms

Twelve bedrooms in the historic Red Row accommodation, six on the lower ground floor and six above, each fitted in bespoke oak and named after English garden plants. The beds are large and handmade; the bathrooms carry roll-top copper tubs, walk-in rainforest showers and proper toiletries. The lower ground floor rooms are dog-friendly. Guests on TripAdvisor describe them as being like having your own suite, and note that the furniture looks as if it was made locally, with care. It was.

Red Row Retreat

Tucked into a secluded corner of the estate, looking across the Beamish Burn valley. Two self-catering suites, Rosemary and Lovage, each has a private outdoor terrace; two stylish doubles, Sage and Thyme, are en suite. Book them separately, or interconnect the lot into one home-from-home that sleeps ten, with its own living space, dining table, fully equipped kitchen, sitting area and writing desk. A new hot tub on the terrace turns it into a romantic countryside getaway. Dogs are welcome for a small nightly charge.

Huckleberry Cottage

A standalone two-bedroom cottage in the peaceful Beamish conservation valley, two or three minutes' stroll from the Black Horse and minutes from Beamish Museum and Tanfield Railway. For guests who want the estate around them and nobody else.

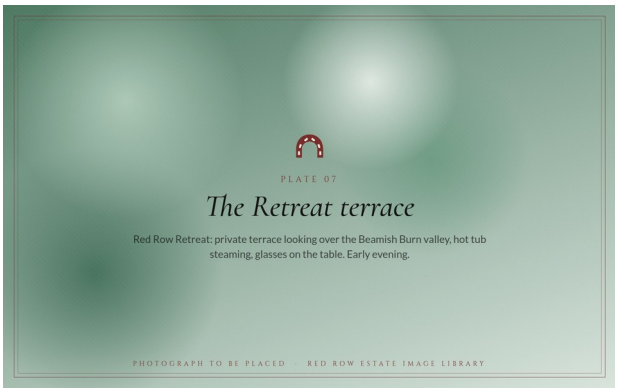


Plate 07 · The Retreat terrace over the Beamish Burn valley.



Plate 08 · Huckleberry Cottage in the conservation valley.

WHO STAYS

- Wedding parties and their guests
- Families visiting Beamish Museum
- Couples on a countryside weekend
- Aston Workshop and Car Barn customers
- Walkers, dog owners, motorhome travellers

IN EVERY ROOM

- Handmade beds and oak-fitted furniture
- Copper roll-top tubs or rainforest showers
- Fridge, safe, television, coffee machine
- Breakfast at the Black Horse from 8am
- The valley outside the window

SECTION 05

Celebrate

Weddings under canvas for 349, or by the fire for forty-five

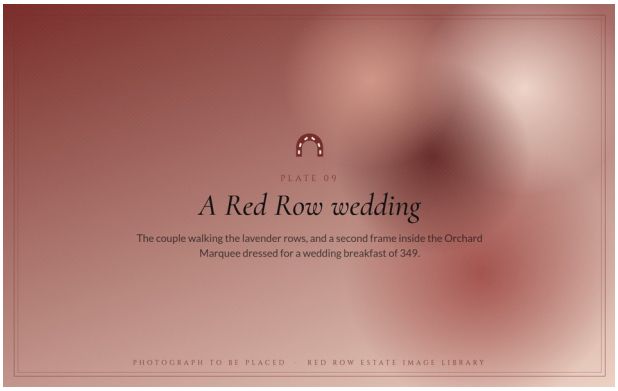


Plate 09 · A Red Row wedding: the couple in the lavender rows; the marquee dressed for 349.

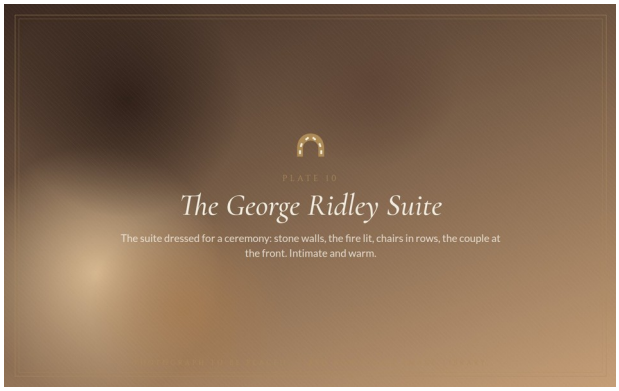


Plate 10 · The George Ridley Suite dressed for a ceremony by the fire.

Two very different rooms, both licensed for civil ceremonies. The Orchard Marquee seats up to 349 for a wedding breakfast and opens onto the estate, which puts it among the largest marquee venues in the county. The George Ridley Suite, with its stone walls and fireplace, takes 54 for a ceremony, 45 for the breakfast and 80 for the evening, and suits a wedding that wants the pub at its heart.

Around them sit eighteen bedrooms, a 300-year-old bar for the night before, a Sunday lunch for the morning after, and a family that has been hosting on this hillside since 2006. The estate is as comfortable with a short-notice winter wedding as with a summer festival celebration, and its private dining, business retreat and Christmas offers use the same rooms all year round.

349	54 · 45 · 80	2	18
SEATED IN THE ORCHARD MARQUEE	GEORGE RIDLEY SUITE: CEREMONY · BREAKFAST · EVENING	ROOMS LICENSED FOR CIVIL CEREMONIES	BEDROOMS ON SITE

The big field

Beyond the marquee, the estate's open ground hosts events at a scale few country venues can match. At its recent editions the Great North Classic Car Show, staged with Aston Workshop, Car Barn and the Beamish Morgan dealership, filled the field with more than 450 classic and exotic cars; there is room for 550 exhibits, a concours d'elegance, an outdoor bar and barbecue, and catering inside the marquee. The same ground and infrastructure are available for supercar and motorcycle gatherings, food and drink festivals, corporate family days, product launches, rural shows, markets, charity events and large private celebrations.



Plate 11 · Show day on the big field: 450 cars, the marquee and the crowds from above.

ALSO ON THE CALENDAR

- Wedding packages, including winter and short-notice dates
- Private dining and celebrations in the pub
- Corporate events and business retreats, with accommodation on site
- Christmas Day lunch in the pub or the marquee; festive stays over Christmas
- Christmas market, movie nights, bingo and live music through the year

SECTION 06

Motoring

The unlikely home of Aston Martin restoration in the North



Plate 12 · Aston Workshop: a DB5 on the lift, and the eighty-car showroom line-up.

Aston Workshop

In 1988 Bob Fountain gave up sheep farming. A friend had rolled up the drive at Red Row in an Aston Martin DB5; Bob converted the sheep shed into a garage, restored a DB5 of his own, sold it, and used the money to start a business. More than three decades later, Aston Workshop is one of the best-known independent Aston Martin specialists in the world, and the tiny hamlet of Red Row is its home.

The site has grown around the farmhouse into two showrooms with space for eighty cars, one of the largest collections of Aston Martins for sale anywhere in the UK, together with service bays, a full restoration workshop, a trim shop, a body shop, an engine assembly room and dynamometer, spray booths, and parts manufacture and distribution for owners around the globe. Bob remains the sole proprietor.

Guided tours run on the first Friday of every month, arriving at 2pm for a 2.30pm start, and take visitors through the showroom, the workshop, the engineering facilities and the body and paint centre. Once a year, on The Hill, the whole estate opens for a celebration of all things Aston: live demonstrations, behind-the-scenes tours, an Aston Martin timeline from pre-war to present, drop-in question sessions with the workshop team, and food from the Black Horse. The 2026 edition is on Sunday 9 August; Aston Martin owners can claim a free ticket so their car has a place on the field.

Car Barn

Founded by Bob and run by his son Fraser, Car Barn is the North East's leading independent sports, prestige and classic car specialist. Its showroom shares the estate with Aston Workshop and the Black Horse, and in 2025 it joined the Caterham Cars UK retailer network as Caterham Car Barn Beamish, alongside names such as Caterham Silverstone and Caterham

Williams. It is also an INEOS Grenadier servicing agent.

Car Barn is where the estate's motoring community gathers. The Car Barn Drivers' Club brings owners of classics, performance cars and specialist vehicles to Red Row for monthly meets, with coffee and breakfast from the pub, and the estate's field and marquee give club gatherings room to grow into full-scale shows.

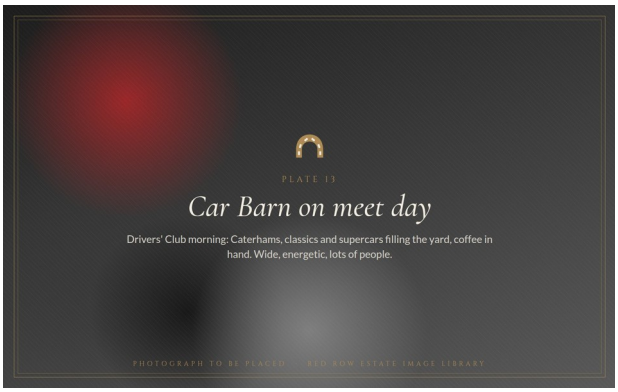


Plate 13 · Car Barn on meet day: Caterhams, classics and supercars filling the yard.

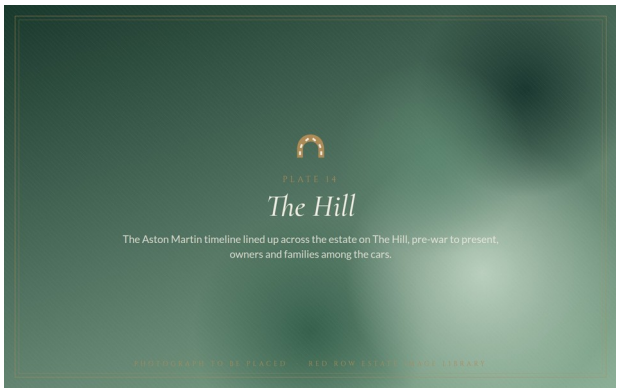


Plate 14 · The Hill: the Aston Martin timeline lined up across the estate.

> *"Over thirty-five years ago the tiny hamlet of Red Row, Beamish, became the unlikely home of Aston Martin restoration in the North."*
>
> ASTON WORKSHOP, ON ITS OWN HISTORY

1988	80	1st Fri	9 Aug	2025
ASTON WORKSHOP FOUNDED	CARS ACROSS TWO SHOWROOMS	WORKSHOP TOURS, MONTHLY	THE HILL 2026	CATERHAM RETAILER

SECTION 07

The open road

Free stopovers for motorhomes and campervans, all year round

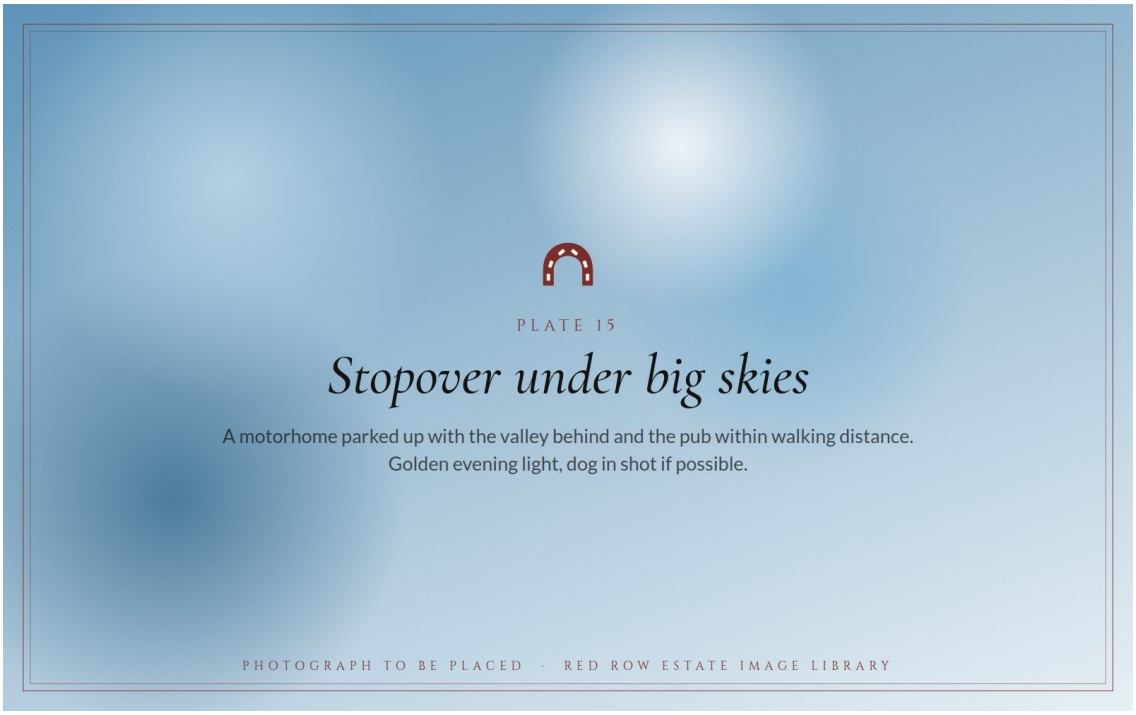


Plate 15 · Stopover under big skies: a motorhome parked up, the valley behind, the pub a short walk away.

The proposition could not be simpler. Arrive, park, relax, eat, explore, sleep. Red Row welcomes motorhomes and campervans to stop overnight, free, all year round, on a first-come, first-served basis. The Black Horse is a short walk away for breakfast, a pint or Sunday lunch; the courtyard and bar are dog-friendly; there is a play park for children; and Beamish Museum is a walkable mile down the road.

The stopover has a loyal following among motorhome clubs: it is listed by the Motorhome Stopover Club and recommended on the stopover forums. For a travel desk it is the perfect anchor for a North East road trip: Beamish, Causey Arch, Tanfield Railway and Durham City within half an hour, and a 300-year-old pub at the end of the day.

THE STOPOVER

- Free, all year round
- First come, first served; no booking
- Dog-friendly bar and courtyard
- Children's play park
- Enquiries through the Black Horse

WITHIN REACH

- Beamish Museum: about a mile, walkable
- Causey Arch: under a mile
- Tanfield Railway: just over a mile
- Durham City and Newcastle: half an hour
- Hadrian's Wall and the Northumberland coast: a day trip

SECTION 08

Land and larder

Lavender, orchards, kitchen gardens and a coffee in the making



Plate 16 · Lavender at Red Row in full bloom, the valley beyond.

The lavender field

Lavender is not a crop the North East expects to grow, which is exactly why Red Row's field, set along the edge of the valley with panoramic views over Beamish, is one of the very few in the region. It flowers from late June and draws bees, photographers and wedding parties in roughly equal numbers. The estate is exploring what comes next: essential-oil production, lavender in the kitchen and the rooms, and a season of open days.

Field to plate

Ten acres of the estate are given over to vegetable gardens and orchards that supply the Black Horse kitchen, so the phrase ‘field to plate’ on the menu describes a walk of a few hundred yards rather than a marketing idea. The woodland is left largely to itself and to the wildlife that lives in it.

Red Row Estate Coffee



The newest of the estate's projects, and still in the making: a plan to source green beans and roast them in small batches under the estate's own name. The aim is for coffee roasted at Red Row to be served at the Black Horse, in the rooms and at the Car Barn meets, and to carry the estate's name beyond the valley.

Plate 17 · Red Row Estate Coffee.

SECTION 09

The Fountain family

Sheep farmer, Aston restorer, publican, host



Plate 18 · Bob beside a DB5 in the former sheep shed; Bob and Fraser at the bar.

Bob Fountain first walked into the Black Horse as a young customer fifty-five years ago. He has lived at Red Row for forty-five of them, first as a sheep farmer in a cottage from the 1690s with two acres, then as the man who turned the sheep shed into an Aston Martin workshop, and from 2006 as the owner of the pub he had been drinking in for three decades.

That sequence, farmer to restorer to publican, is the whole estate in one life. Aston Workshop paid for the cottages; the cottages became the rooms; the pub became the venue; the field became the show ground; the lavender and the coffee are what the family is planting now. The estate has grown field by field from those two acres to thirty-seven. His son Fraser runs Car Barn and the Drivers' Club, so the next generation is already on the estate.

For a feature writer the Fountains offer something rare: a family-owned country estate that is still being built by the people who built it, with a founder who can walk a journalist from the bar where he drank as a young man to the lift where a DB5 is being restored, without leaving his own land.

INTERVIEW AND ACCESS

- Bob Fountain is available for interview at the Black Horse or on the estate, by arrangement.
- Fraser Fountain is available on Car Barn, Caterham, the Drivers' Club and the estate's motoring events.
- Workshop, showroom, rooms, marquee and lavender field can all be opened for photography and filming.
- Overnight stays for travel writers can be arranged in Old Red Row Rooms or the Retreat.

SECTION 10

Story angles

Twelve pitches, ready to commission

Each of these can be written from this pack, a phone call and a morning on the estate. Images exist or can be arranged for every one.

The 300-year-old pub built for the Shafto estate's miners

Ten cottages, one able-bodied man per lease for the quarry or the pit, twenty-eight people under one roof in 1851, and a restoration that took four years.

Regional features · heritage titles · CAMRA · BBC Look North

Fifty-five years a customer, forty-five years a neighbour, twenty a landlord

Bob Fountain's life on Red Row, from the bar he drank in as a young man to the pub he restored.

Weekend supplements · Living North · The Northern Echo

The oldest pub in the Vaux estate

A Sunderland brewery, a favourite pub, and brewery guests arriving by dray. Being verified now; a strong North East brewing-history piece when it is.

Regional heritage · beer and pub titles

The County Durham hamlet that became an Aston Martin destination

From a DB5 in a sheep shed to eighty cars in two showrooms and owners flying in from around the world.

Classic & Sports Car · Octane · Classic Driver · national motoring

Caterham comes north

Car Barn Beamish joins the Caterham retailer network; a Sunday morning with the Drivers' Club.

Motoring press · regional business · Autocar and evo

The Hill, 9 August 2026

A free-to-owners celebration of Aston Martin on a working estate, with live demonstrations and a timeline from pre-war to today.

Event listings · motoring calendars · regional what's-on

Britain's best pub stopover?

Free, first come first served, dogs welcome, a 300-year-old bar and Beamish Museum on foot.

Practical Motorhome · MMM · Camping & Caravanning · travel desks

A wedding for 349 in an orchard

Among the largest marquee venues in County Durham, with eighteen bedrooms and a pub attached.

Wedding titles · Bridebook · regional lifestyle

Lavender in the North East

One of the region's only lavender fields, in full bloom above the Beamish valley from late June.

Country Living · gardening press · regional picture desks (July)

Field to plate, literally

Ten acres of vegetable gardens and orchards a few hundred yards from the kitchen door; a Sunday lunch that changes every week.

Food titles · Sunday lunch round-ups · Great British Food

Beamish's other attraction

The museum draws the crowds; a mile up the hill is where they eat, sleep and park. A perfect add-on for museum coverage.

Family travel · days-out guides · This is Durham

A family estate still being built

Farmer, restorer, publican, host, and now roaster: the Fountains and what they are planting next.

Business features · Bdaily · North East Times · Insider

SECTION 11

Facts, figures and boilerplate

Numbers to quote, descriptions to lift, people to call

ITEM	DETAIL
Location	Red Row, Beamish, County Durham DH9 0RW. In the Beamish conservation valley, about a mile from Beamish Museum.
Estate	37 acres: pasture, woodland, ten acres of vegetable gardens and orchards, lavender field.
The Black Horse	Built c.1690 as the first of ten cottages on the Shafto family's Beamish estate; licensed c.1850; 28 residents in the 1851 census; bought 2006; restored over four years; reopened 2010.
Bar and dining	Breakfast daily 8 to 10am; all-day dining Mon to Sat 12 to 9pm; afternoon tea Mon to Sat 12 to 4pm; Sunday lunch 12 to 6pm; two changing cask ales.
Old Red Row Rooms	12 bedrooms (6 lower ground, dog-friendly; 6 upper); bespoke oak; handmade beds; copper roll-top tubs.
Red Row Retreat	Suites Rosemary and Lovage with private terraces; doubles Sage and Thyme; interconnects to sleep 10; hot tub; dog-friendly.
Huckleberry Cottage	Standalone two-bedroom cottage, 2 to 3 minutes' walk from the pub.
Weddings	Orchard Marquee: 349 seated. George Ridley Suite: 54 ceremony, 45 breakfast, 80 evening. Both licensed for civil ceremonies.
Outdoor events	Great North Classic Car Show: 450+ cars shown; space for 550 exhibits; concours; outdoor bar and barbecue; marquee catering.
Aston Workshop	Founded 1988 by Bob Fountain, sole proprietor. Two showrooms, 80-car capacity; restoration, trim, body, engine and dyno, paint, parts. Tours on the first Friday of the month: 2pm arrival, 2.30pm start.
Car Barn	Run by Fraser Fountain. Sports, prestige and classic cars; official Caterham retailer since 2025; INEOS Grenadier servicing; Drivers' Club monthly meets.
The Hill 2026	Sunday 9 August, 10am, Red Row Estate. Free tickets for Aston Martin owners.
Stopovers	Motorhomes and campervans: free, all year, first come first served. Dog-friendly bar and courtyard; play park.

Boilerplate, short

Red Row Estate is a 37-acre family-owned country estate in the Beamish valley, County Durham, centred on the 300-year-old Black Horse Beamish and home to Old Red Row Rooms, Red Row Retreat, Huckleberry Cottage, the Orchard Marquee, Aston Workshop and Car Barn.

Boilerplate, long

Red Row Estate is a historic countryside estate in the Beamish conservation valley, County Durham, a mile from Beamish Museum. Owned and run by the Fountain family, it is centred on the Black Horse Beamish, an inn built around 1690 as the first of the Shafto estate's Red Row cottages and restored over four years to

reopen in 2010. Around the pub the estate brings together eighteen bedrooms across Old Red Row Rooms, Red Row Retreat and Huckleberry Cottage; two licensed wedding venues, the Orchard Marquee for up to 349 guests and the George Ridley Suite; open ground for major outdoor events including the Great North Classic Car Show; Aston Workshop, the internationally known Aston Martin specialist founded on the estate in 1988; Car Barn, an official Caterham retailer; free stopovers for motorhomes and campervans; and thirty-seven acres of woodland, orchards, kitchen gardens and one of the North East's only lavender fields.

Media contact

RED ROW ESTATE

Red Row, Beamish
County Durham DH9 0RW
01207 232569
stay@blackhorsebeamish.co.uk
blackhorsebeamish.co.uk

MOTORING ENQUIRIES

Aston Workshop: aston.co.uk
Car Barn: carbarn.co.uk
The Hill: aston.co.uk/thehill
Social: @blackhorsebeamish
Press contact: name, mobile and direct email to be inserted here

PEOPLE

Bob Fountain Owner of Red Row Estate and the Black Horse Beamish; founder and sole proprietor of Aston Workshop

Fraser Fountain Runs Car Barn and the Car Barn Drivers' Club

NAMES AND SPELLINGS

Red Row Estate is the master brand; Black Horse Beamish (not 'the Black Horse Inn') is the pub and rooms · Old Red Row Rooms · Red Row Retreat · Huckleberry Cottage · the Orchard Marquee · the George Ridley Suite · Aston Workshop · Car Barn Beamish, trading as Caterham Car Barn Beamish · The Hill · Red Row Estate Coffee

OWNER'S APPENDIX

Working material

The two sections that follow, the image library and the notes and checks, are for the owner and the estate team. They should be removed before the pack goes to journalists.

SECTION 12

Image library

Eighteen plates, the shot briefs, and where pictures already exist

Every plate in this pack marks a photograph the estate should hold at print resolution. Where an image already exists it is listed; where it does not, the brief is written for a photographer or a drone pilot. Own photography, supplied to journalists on request, is worth more than any stock image: it gives editors something they cannot get elsewhere.

NO.	SUBJECT	BRIEF	EXISTING SOURCE
01	Beamish valley from Red Row	Hero aerial or elevated view: estate, lavender, woodland, the pub in its landscape. Drone, golden hour, landscape.	To commission
02	The Black Horse at dusk	Exterior with lights in the windows and the cottages behind. Blue hour.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk; TripAdvisor galleries (reference only)
03	Firelight and flagstones	Bar interior: fire, flagstones, eclectic furniture; close frame of the matchbox collection.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk; TripAdvisor bar and lounge gallery (reference only)
04	Sunday lunch at the pass	The roast being plated, or afternoon tea on the stand by the fire. Overhead and close.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk/ sunday-lunch and /afternoon-tea; to commission
05	Red Row in the archive	Oldest photograph of the pub or cottages, paired with today's view; the 1740 lease.	Family and local archives; Durham University Special Collections; Beamish Museum archive
06	An Old Red Row bedroom	Handmade bed dressed, oak, copper tub in shot. Bright, uncluttered.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk/ old-red-row-rooms
07	The Retreat terrace	Terrace over the valley, hot tub steaming, early evening.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk/ redrow; This is Durham listing
08	Huckleberry Cottage	Exterior in the valley plus one atmospheric interior.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk/ huckleberry-cottage; This is Durham
09	A Red Row wedding	Couple in the lavender rows; marquee interior dressed for 349.	Wedding photographers (with permission); Bridebook; Real Weddings
10	The George Ridley Suite	Dressed for a ceremony: stone walls, fire lit, chairs in rows.	blackhorsebeamish.co.uk/ red-row-estate-weddings; wedding photographers
11	Show day on the big field	Elevated or drone view: 450 cars, marquee, crowds.	Great North Classic Car Show archive; Flickr album 2019
12	Aston Workshop	DB5 on the lift with craftsman; the eighty-car showroom line-up.	aston.co.uk; Classic & Sports Car; Living North
13	Car Barn on meet day	Drivers' Club morning: Caterhams, classics, supercars, people.	carbarn.co.uk; Caterham Cars announcement; Car Barn Facebook

NO.	SUBJECT	BRIEF	EXISTING SOURCE
14	The Hill	The Aston Martin timeline across the estate, owners among the cars.	aston.co.uk/thehill; previous editions' photography
15	Stopover under big skies	Motorhome parked, valley behind, pub in walking distance. Golden light; dog if possible.	Motorhome Stopover Club listing; to commission
16	Lavender at Red Row	Rows in full bloom with the valley beyond; close frame of bees. Late June to July.	Estate archive; to commission in season
17	Red Row Estate Coffee	Roaster at work if it exists by press time; otherwise a branded cup on the bar, fire behind.	To commission
18	The Fountain family	Bob beside a DB5 in the former sheep shed; Bob and Fraser at the bar.	To commission; Living North and Bdaily features
Map	Estate map	A simple illustrated map: pub, rooms, Retreat, cottage, marquee, workshop, Car Barn, stopover, the mile to the museum.	To commission from an illustrator

Where pictures already exist

- **blackhorsebeamish.co.uk**: galleries on the stay, rooms, Retreat, cottage, weddings, marquee, stopover and Aston tour pages.
- **TripAdvisor**: the hotel and restaurant galleries. Useful as a reference for what guests love to photograph, not for publication: guest photos are not licensed for press use.
- **Flickr and Instagram**: the estate's own Flickr account (blackhorsebeamish) and @blackhorsebeamish on Instagram and TikTok; the Great North Classic Car Show 2019 Flickr album.
- **aston.co.uk and carbarn.co.uk**: workshop, showroom and event photography; the Caterham Cars press announcement.
- **Wedding photographers**: the strongest wedding images will be in photographers' portfolios; secure written permission and a credit line before supplying to press.

GUIDANCE FOR THE FINAL PACK

- Landscapes: horizontal, high resolution, shot at golden hour or blue hour.
- Buildings: both close architectural detail and the wider setting.
- People: natural photographs of the family and staff; staff and guests in event shots.
- Aston Workshop and Car Barn: genuine workshop and meet images, showing scale and not only single cars.
- Rooms: bright and uncluttered; weddings: the countryside in frame; motorhomes: the experience, not the vehicle.
- Supply as JPEG at 300 dpi, longest edge at least 4,000 pixels, with credit lines and permissions recorded.

SECTION 13

Notes and checks

What is verified, what is family account, and what is still being checked

Three kinds of claim appear in this pack. Documented facts come from the estate's own published material, the CAMRA listing, the Caterham Cars and Aston Workshop announcements, regional press and public archives. Family account is history passed down at Red Row, told in good faith and flagged wherever it appears. Items still being checked are listed here so that nothing reaches a journalist as verified before it is.

Family account, flagged in the text

- Vaux Breweries of Sunderland acquiring the Black Horse in 1926, and the pub being the oldest in the Vaux estate.
- A Nicholson associated with Vaux regarding the Black Horse as a favourite and bringing International Brewery Club guests by dray.
- The matchbox tradition's origin with earlier landlords.

Being checked before external distribution

1. Exact date and origin of the Black Horse building, and the relationship between the 1740 Red Row lease in the Shafto (Beamish) Papers and the present building. The Shafto link needs care: Bobby Shafto of the song was born in 1732, so the c.1690 cottages predate him; the pack now says 'the Shafto family's estate'.
2. The 1926 Vaux acquisition, the oldest-pub claim, the identity of the Nicholson referred to, and any International Brewery Club visits, against Vaux brewery records; any historic dray photographs.
3. The exact wording of the CAMRA Durham branch description, for quotation.
4. Outdoor event capacity, parking, licensing and event limits for the big field.
5. Current stopover terms: free status, maximum stay, facilities, any restrictions.
6. Accommodation counts and descriptions, including the Retreat hot tub and the total bedroom count across the three properties.
7. Press email, direct owner contact and social-media handles for the contact page.
8. The Red Row Estate Coffee and lavender essential-oil projects: current status and what can be said publicly.
9. Timeline dates: when Old Red Row Rooms, the Retreat, the Orchard Marquee and Car Barn opened; the first car show and the first The Hill; whether the car show returns in 2026.
10. The Retreat's room count: the website lists two suites and two doubles; the owner's draft lists six rooms and two apartments. The pack uses eighteen bedrooms in total until this is settled.
11. Still to add: the Red Row Estate, Black Horse Beamish, Aston Workshop and Car Barn logos, which then replace the horseshoe device on the cover, section bands and footer; the eighteen photographs and the estate map; any historic Vaux material.

RED ROW ESTATE

Come and see it for yourself.
The kettle and the fire are always on.

Red Row, Beamish, County Durham DH9 0RW

01207 232569 · stay@blackhorsebeamish.co.uk

blackhorsebeamish.co.uk · aston.co.uk · carbarn.co.uk

@BLACKHORSEBEAMISH · INSTAGRAM · FACEBOOK · TIKTOK